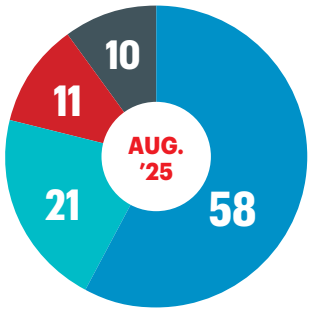
Q. Is India capable of holding the Olympics in 2036?



A majority of respondents express confidence; a fifth do not dismiss the possibility

stands tall—Smriti Mandhana. All eyes will be on the ICC Women's ODI Cricketer of the Year 2024, one of our most talented batters ever, as she looks to claim the one thing that has been missing in her storied career so far—an ICC team trophy. Needless to say, if the Women in Blue want to open their account, Mandhana needs to fire on all cylinders in the Women's Cricket World Cup. The tournament could also be captain Harmanpreet Kaur's last attempt to craft a legacy of her own.

In the non-cricketing world, double Olympic medallist Neeraj Chopra is still the athlete to beat, as is shuttler P.V. Sindhu in women's badminton. But India's wunderkinds in chess are getting noticed too. Grandmasters D. Gukesh, recent World Cup winner Divya Deshmukh (making her top five debut) and Ramesh Praggnanandhaa and his sister R. Vaishali were all recognised for their feats in the latest poll. But the presence of 41-year-old football legend Sunil Chhetri, who came back from retirement to help the struggling team, and Olympic medallists Mirabai Chanu, Manu Bhaker and Lovlina Borgohain, signify India's lack of sporting accomplishments in the international arena, with respondents rewarding recall value rather than recent performances. ■

Q. Who is India's No. 1 sportsman?



1. **NEERAJ CHOPRA** *(Athletics)* **33.9** [39.1]
2. **SUNIL CHHETRI** *(Football)* **13.6** [17.2]
3. **D. GUKESH** **8.9** [12.2]
4. **R. PRAGGNANANDHAA** *(Chess)* **2.7** [0.4]
5. **CHIRAG SHETTY & S.S. RANKIREDDY** *(Badminton)* **1.8** [3.6]

Q. Who is India's No. 1 sportswoman?

1. **P.V. SINDHU** *(Badminton)* **40** [40.1]
2. **MIRABAI CHANU** *(Weightlifting)* **4.8** [6.8]
3. **DIVYA DESHMUKH** *(Chess)* **3** [0.1]
4. **MANU BHAKER** *(Shooting)* **2.3** [9.7]
5. **LOVLINA BORGOHAIN** *(Boxing)* **1.8** [0.6]



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Q. WHO IS INDIA'S NO. 1 FEMALE CRICKETER?

1. **SMRITI MANDHANA** **53.4** [42.3]
2. **HARMANPREET KAUR** **10.1** [8.7]
3. **DEEPTI SHARMA** **6.2** [8]
4. **SHAFALI VERMA** **4.1** [13.1]
5. **RAJESHWARI GAYAKWAD** **1** [0.1]

DK/ CS: Don't know/ can't say; all figures in %; rest, others; Aug. '25 figures in bold, Feb. '25 in [ ]